DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 1

Social media manager

Profession 1 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A social media manager plans, creates, publishes and reports on a brand's social channels, including social media marketing for small businesses.

What professionals do every day

Plans the content calendar, writes captions, briefs graphics, schedules posts, replies to comments and messages, and reports results monthly.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Brands need steady, relevant presence and fast replies. A manager keeps the channels active and measures what drives enquiries.

- Inconsistent posting that loses followers.
- Comments and messages left unanswered.
- Content that gets reach but no enquiries.

Skills you need

- Content planning and formats.
- Captioning and hashtags.
- Basic graphic design (Canva).
- Analytics and reporting.
- Strong ability with spreadsheets and the platform's native tools

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Meta Business Suite	Facebook and Instagram management	Free	Ads cost extra	business.facebook.com
Buffer	Scheduling	Free tier	Paid plans	buffer.com
Canva	Graphics	Free	Paid plans	www.canva.com
Metricool	Analytics	Free tier	Paid plans	metricool.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Post a week of content for one account.
Intermediate	Reply to 20 comments with a consistent voice.

Advanced	Produce a monthly report with three findings.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Monthly content package for a café.
- **Intermediate:** Community management for a clinic.
- **Advanced:** Launch campaign for a course.

Client-ready portfolio project

The 30-day plan project (Part 2) plus a monthly report with three findings and three next actions.

Worked example

Worked example. A post with a three-line hook performs better than a long caption. The manager tests two hooks on similar posts and keeps the winner.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Monthly report with findings

Business problem: A café's monthly report must show what worked.

Steps

1. Pull reach, saves and enquiries per post for the month.
2. Rank the top three posts and explain why they worked.
3. Name three actions for next month.
4. Write the report in one page.

Expected output: A one-page report with data and actions.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The report ties each finding to a number and each action to a finding. Saves and enquiries matter more than likes for this client.

Common mistakes

- Posting without a plan.
- Chasing likes instead of enquiries.
- Using stolen images or music.
- Replying late to customers.

Freelancing opportunities

- Monthly retainers for small brands.
- Launch campaigns and content packages.

- Briefs for 'social media manager', 'Instagram management', 'content calendar'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Meta Blueprint (official learning)
- Google Skillshop

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